One of the more intriguing aspects of Iron Man's design revolved around the question of how Tony Stark would manage donning his armor. In other words, how is Iron Man going to "suit up?" The Micro-Robotic Assembly System, though unused in the film, reminded designers of the effectiveness of the army of robots at Stark's disposal. When the suit up sequence was being developed in post-production, concept artist Phil Saunders was asked to deliver some pre-visual art to help conceive the scene. He went to town on a series of thumbnail storyboards (right, page 96-97) that walked the sequence through memorable storytelling beats. One post-production challenge for this scene was not having an actor to work with.

SAUNDERS: "The big mandate here was to try and do as much as possible without actually having to have the actor involved. Robert Downey, Jr. had moved on to another film and to bring him back was going to be very difficult. A lot of this sequence was based on creating shots that hid his face so we could use a stunt double, or working in a lot of detailed insert shots to focus on smaller events. Our goal was to have this be a fast-paced and well-choreographed shot. Give it a sense of overlapping motion, with one part of the robotic system retracting, another coming in, no dead space, everything happening just in time. Everything had to have this immaculate sense of precision."

Page 97, bottom: Suit up gantry keyframe art (Ryan Meinerding)



